Free and Informed Consent Form (FICF)

This document, called the Free and Informed Consent Form (FICF), aims to ensure your rights as a participant and will be provided electronically.

Please read it carefully and calmly, seeking to understand the research proposal fully. There will be no penalties or harm if you choose not to participate or withdraw your consent at any time.

INFORMATION ABOUT THIS RESEARCH:

Objective: This research aims to explore the characterization of software security practices commonly adopted by developers. We also aim to understand how developers deal with the use of automated security tools and the challenges they face when adopting and using such tools.

Significance of the study: This study aims to provide valuable insights into different software security practices, as well as the factors related to the adoption of automated security tools.

Procedures and methodology: To participate in this study, **you must be over 18 years of age and work in the field of software development or information security.** Participation involves completing an online questionnaire about software security practices and automated security tools, which will take approximately 15 minutes to complete. Participants' confidentiality and anonymity will be strictly maintained, encouraging frank and honest responses in order to provide valuable insights into the topic under investigation.

Data handling: Throughout the process, respect for privacy and ethical standards will be ensured, as prescribed by the General Data Protection Law (Law No. 13.709/2018), guaranteeing that participants' information is treated confidentially. The data collected through the online questionnaire will be anonymized, removing any information that could directly identify participants. The data will be organized and coded to facilitate analysis. The results will be presented in an aggregated and non-identifiable manner, thereby preserving participants' privacy in accordance with applicable legal provisions.

Contact information for researchers: Whenever you wish, you can contact us for information about this research project, your participation, or other research-related matters. The researchers involved in this study are: Carlos Adriel (adrielbastos@alu.ufc.br). The supervising faculty members are: Anderson Uchôa (andersonuchoa@ufc.br), Carla Bezerra (carlailane@ufc.br) and Joanna Cecilia (jdasilv2@nd.edu).

GUARANTEES TO PARTICIPANTS:

Right to refuse to participate: At any time, you may refuse to participate and withdraw from the research without any embarrassment, penalties, or any detriment. The information and materials obtained in this research will not be used for any purposes other than those within this context.

Confidentiality and privacy: We guarantee total confidentiality and anonymity of your responses. All sensitive information, such as names of companies or other individuals, will be completely anonymized.

Responsibility of the Researcher: We ensure that this document is provided to the research participant and that the data obtained will be used exclusively for the purposes described in this document or as consented by the participant.